

New Apple Intelligence features

And how to make them better

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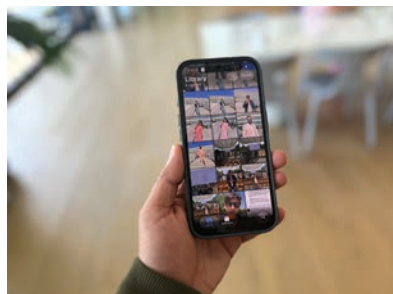
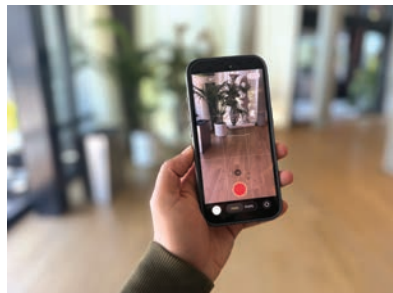
At WWDC 2025, Apple largely focused on a design overhaul across devices. Liquid Glass – which is now its new design interface – will now power all Apple devices including the iPhones, iPads, Macs and even the Apple Watches. Meanwhile Apple Intelligence took a new direction and will now be more deeply integrated across the ecosystem, including iOS 26, macOS 26 Tahoe, iPadOS 26, and watchOS 26.

Along with this, Apple also introduced some new Apple Intelligence features that build on last year's updates like Writing Tools, smart summaries for Messages and Mail, and its recent ChatGPT integration.

I got a close look at some of these features during different sessions and briefings held at the Apple Park during the ongoing developer conference. Some of these are definitely interesting and useful updates, but some of them also require some work. So, here is a bit of a round-up of new Apple Intelligence features coming to your devices, along with some feedback for Apple engineers. Please, take note!

Live translation in Messages, Phone and FaceTime

This was one of the most obvious updates and had to arrive on Apple devices at some point. So, Apple Intelligence can translate your conversations real-time across text and voice in different languages. This works on Messages, FaceTime, and Phone for iOS 26, WatchOS 26, iPad OS 26, and macOS Tahoe 26. It works flawlessly in



all the demos I saw at the Apple Park. It also works backwards on Messages, meaning if you enable live translation within a chat, it will translate the older messages as well. Also, there is an option to enable a specific contact. So, everytime you get a message from that person, it will automatically be translated – saving that extra step.

However, that only works on Messages, not calls. There you will have to manually turn it on after picking up.

Apple says it wants the caller to know the conversation is being translated. Honestly, that can happen through an automated voice announcement as soon as the call is picked.

Secondly, live translations don't support group calls or multiple languages as of now. So, you can only use them on 1:1 calls and for converting one language only.

Improvements for Genmoji and Image Playground

With Genmoji, you can now blend multiple emojis and even customize them using Image Playground, be it tweaking facial expressions or changing hair-styles. Image Playground also has built-in ChatGPT integration, so you can generate images using OpenAI's model directly within the tool.

Polls for your group chat

Within group chats, you can now create polls and Apple Intelligence will compile the results. You can add emojis to the polls. Also, people will be able to vote for multiple options. If someone decides not to vote, that will also be visible to the group.

As of now, the polls remain open after creation. I think it will be a good idea to add a time-limit to these polls. It will help people understand the urgency or enable them to make decisions in a given time frame.

Visual Intelligence upgrade

Apple introduced Visual Intelligence on iPhones last year. And, with iOS 26, it has now added a visual search feature by combining Visual Intelligence with Apple Intelligence. How does it work? By taking a screenshot of any app you're looking at, you can use a new search function on the bottom of your screen. It can recognise events from the screenshot and them to your calendar, do a Google search and is also integrated with ChatGPT.

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